

iQOO Neo 7

Most powerful mid-ranger?

The iQOO Neo 7 is the first MediaTek Dimensity 8200-powered smartphone to have launched in India. But, does it live up to the reputation set by the Neo 6? More importantly, is it worth your hard-earned money? Let's find out!!

DESIGN

Beginning with the design, the iQOO Neo 7 doesn't have anything special going for it. The smartphone looks similar to the Neo 6, with the most evident distinction being in the camera module. The smartphone's frame itself is plastic. The front bezels are thinner at just 1.6mm, and the chin is also very thin at just 2.65mm. We get a 93.1 percent screen-to-body ratio, which is one of the highest screen real estate you get in this segment. The smartphone also feels quite lightweight in your hands. We measured the weight using a weighing scale, and it came out to be 194 grams.

DISPLAY

Coming to the display, the colours are true to life and the dynamic range is also good. It may not look as vibrant as some other panels in this range. However, watching YouTube videos and Netflix content is a great experience, thanks to iQOO's Visual Enhancement feature. The details on this display are also pretty good. When scrolling through the UI, watching content, scrolling through feeds, or playing games, the image is always sharp and there are no signs of pixelation or lack of quality at any time. It is also super responsive and bright, with the 120Hz refresh rate. Coming to brightness, iQOO claims a peak brightness of 1,300 nits on the iQOO Neo 7, but according to our Lux Meter test, the iQOO Neo 7's display peaked out at 852 nits of maximum brightness, with the lowest being 7 nits.

₹29,999



Features82
Build and Design ...53
Performance84
Value for Money....79

PERFORMANCE

The smartphone feels super fast from the moment you open it up and start using it.

In our on AnTuTu Test, the iQOO Neo 7 scored an impressive 857,930 score, which is much higher than its predecessor's score of around 750,000. On Geekbench 5, the iQOO Neo 7 gave us a single-core score of 1,006 and a multi-core score of 3,922. In PC Mark Work, the iQOO Neo 7 scored 10,992 points. Now, this isn't the highest in the category, but still pretty good for a mid-range smartphone. In the 3D Mark Wildlife test, the iQOO Neo 7 scored 6,591 points. We also played several games on the iQOO Neo 7. These include Call of Duty: Mobile, Genshin Impact and Asphalt 9. All these games ran pretty smoothly, and on the highest-possible graphics and FPS settings. It does heat up a little bit after long, strenuous sessions of full throttle load, but it's not the worst we have seen on a smartphone. We measured the temperature using a Flir heat camera while the smartphone was running GPU benchmarks, and it showed the highest temperature of 45.9 degrees Celsius.

BATTERY

The smartphone's battery backup is decent, unless you make it work hard.

We ran several tests on the smartphone and found the battery to be draining a bit faster than what we have seen in similar smartphones. Overall, iQOO Neo 7 in our testing easily gave us more than 6 hours of on-screen time, which is quite good for any smartphone. Coming to the charging, the smartphone charged its battery from 0 to 100 percent in just under 29 minutes with the help of iQOO's 120W fast charging.

CAMERA

Coming to cameras, you can easily click good images with this camera. The smartphone blows up the colours and highlights in low light conditions, mostly to make the images look more aesthetic and colourful. In extremely low light conditions, the images lose detail and the colours are blown up. In ideal lighting conditions, however, this camera is very good. The front camera on the Neo 7 clicks very good selfies in good lighting conditions. In low light as well, the images out of this selfie shooter are good, but lose out on detail.

VERDICT

The iQOO Neo 7 is almost too good for a mid-range smartphone. The battery drains a bit too quickly in some cases, but the super-fast charging more than makes up for it. The design of the smartphone doesn't stand out as such. So, is the iQOO Neo 7 worth your Rs 29,999? Yes. However, if you want a more camera-centric smartphone, then you should look at the Redmi Note 12 Pro+. If you are all about design, the Realme 10 Pro+ or the new Oppo Reno 8T are your options.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: MediaTek Dimensity 8200 | GPU: Mali-G610 MC6 | OS: Funtouch OS 13 based on Android 13 | Display: 6.78-inch FHD+ E5 AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: Up to 12GB | ROM: Up to 256GB | Cameras (rear): 64MP + 2MP + 2MP | Cameras (front): 16MP | Video: 4K @ 30fps | Battery: 5000mAh | Charging: 120W

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